

FIELD LIBRARY / ACTION CHECKLIST

Chest pain & suspected heart attack

MEDICAL / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

New chest pressure, squeezing or unexplained discomfort with shortness of breath, sweating, nausea or pain in the jaw, back or arm can be a heart attack. Stop activity, call the local emergency number and rest. Do not drive yourself.

Do now.

- ☐ **Stop and seek urgent care**
01 Help the person rest in a comfortable position. Request emergency medical assistance and an AED if someone can bring one.
- ☐ **Stay nearby**
02 Monitor breathing and responsiveness. Symptoms can be subtle or come and go; do not wait for a textbook pattern.
- ☐ **Use medicines carefully**
03 Assist with the person's own prescribed medication as directed. Ask a dispatcher or clinician about aspirin; avoid it if contraindicated, allergic, unable to swallow, or uncertain.
- ☐ **If they collapse**
04 If unresponsive and not breathing normally, begin CPR and use an AED promptly. A heart attack can lead to cardiac arrest.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Keep contacting reachable medical care and a trusted local helper while the person rests. Confirm whether assistance is actually coming and ask a clinician about transport when ambulance access fails. The affected person must not drive; household planning cannot replace urgent treatment.

Watch for.

Chest discomfort is not always a heart attack, and absence of chest pain does not exclude one. Do not diagnose it using an online checklist or exertion test.

People & practical needs.

Choose one person to remain with the patient and one to communicate. Prepare a concise medication and allergy list, leave room for first aid and keep dependents supervised

Next decision.

Arrange urgent evaluation even if pain eases. Record symptom onset and any medicine taken, including dose and time.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

INCIDENT / SYMPTOM ONSET / LOCATION

HELP REQUESTED / RESPONSE CONFIRMED

SOURCES / SCOPE / LIMITS

Source-linked civilian guidance, not independent clinical or specialist certification. U.S. references; emergency numbers and services differ. Training and product instructions remain essential.

American Red Cross – Heart Attack

AHA / Red Cross – 2024 first-aid guidelines

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/heart-attack/>